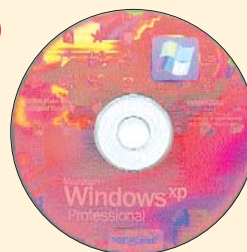


How would you create a Windows XP CD that can pre-install your favourite programs along with XP?

Send in your solution with the subject "Take a Crack", and your postal address, to takeacrack@thinkdigit.com

Create A Bootable XP CD That Pre-installs Additional Programs



LAST MONTH'S CHALLENGE

Win!



Take a Crack and win

DCOM Application Development

by Jonathan Pinnock

Published by

WILEY-INDIA

LAST MONTH'S WINNER

Pradeep Bishnoiwinner!
Jodhpur, Rajasthan

Rules and Regulations

Readers are requested to send in their answers by the 15th of the month of publication.

Employees of Jasubhai Digital Media and their relatives are not permitted to participate in this contest.

Readers are encouraged to send their replies by e-mail. Jasubhai Digital Media will not entertain any unsolicited communication.

Jasubhai Digital Media is not responsible for any damage to your system that may be caused while you are trying to solve the problem.

Change The Default Drive Tools In XP

Last month's solution

Windows XP bundles some utilities to take care of common problems. The defragmenter brings scattered data together to boost file access speed. Scandisk checks for and fixes disk errors. Disk Cleanup sweeps unwanted files off your hard drive, and Backup backs up your files.

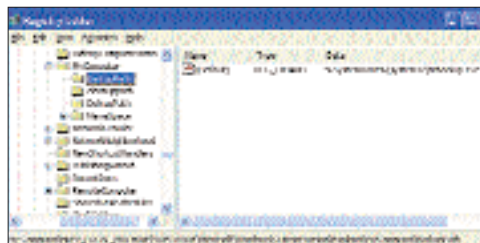
While these utilities do what they claim to do, there are many other utilities that can do the same and more. Let's see how the default tools in XP can be replaced by such third-party utilities.

You first need to download those software, of course. We suggest the following three tools.

- 1. Diskeeper from www.diskeeper.com. This is a defragmenting tool which is an excellent replacement for the standard defragmenter in Windows.
- 2. Disk Cleaner, a freeware from www.diskcleaner.nl. A drive cleaning tool that can clean your system better than can the Windows utility.
- 3. Paragon Drive Backup Personal 8.0 from www.drive-backup.com—a versatile backup utility.

Note again that the tools specified here are only our suggestions. Any other similar software can be used.

Install all these software to any location. You must remember the path to where the software is installed so that you can later retrieve the path to the .exe. Then open the Registry Editor.



Change the default backup tool using Regedit

Navigate to the Key
`HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\SOFTWARE\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Explorer\MyComputer`

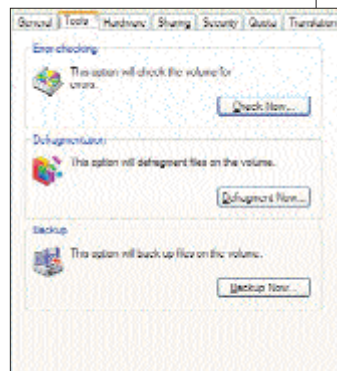
This has four keys named Backuppath, Cleanuppath, Defragpath, and Namespace. First click on the Backuppath key. You'll be able to see its "Default" Value on the right side: `"%SystemRoot%\system32\ntbackup.exe"`

Change this to new value—give the path of the backup utility executable. Now it becomes something like `"C:/Program Files/paragon/diskbackup.exe"`.

Do a similar operation for the other two. For example, for Defragpath, click the key and change its Default Value to `"C:/Program Files/diskkeeper/diskkeeper.exe"`. And similarly for Cleanuppath.

If you want to replace Scandisk with a third-party utility, modify or create a key called `"ChkDskPath"` at the same level as the aforementioned keys. Click the key then change its Default Value to `"C:/Program Files/DiskScanner/Diskscan.exe"`. Note that the path and the program file name in this case are dummy values—replace them with the proper values for the program you want to install.

Close the Registry Editor. Refresh the Desktop or log off and log back on. You're ready to use your own tools as the defaults in Windows XP. ■



Launch the new drive tools from the same old dialog